

Introduction

DARLA MOORE SCHOOL OF BUSINESS



HR@Moore Survey of Chief Human Resource Officers

Welcome to the 2025 HR@Moore Survey of Chief Human Resource Officers.

This year, the survey is being conducted by the Center for Executive Succession at the Darla Moore School of Business, University of South Carolina, in partnership with the Human Resource Policy Association. It has been led by Patrick Wright working in conjunction with the following CHROs:

2025 HR@Moore CHRO Survey Advisory Board

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Human Resource Policy Association

Tim Bartl President and CEO	Ani Huang Senior Executive Vice President
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Instructions

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The purpose of this survey is to explore the CHRO role and understand how CHROs address their organization's challenges. Our hope is to provide CHROs with data regarding key leverage points which will increase their effectiveness, particularly regarding interfaces with the Board of Directors and other members of the Executive Leadership Team.

This year we focus on changing diversity, equity and inclusion practices, leadership capabilities, sustainability, change management, disruptions to corporate culture and CEO succession.

All answers are confidential and are seen only by the researchers administering the survey.

- No data will be released that is not aggregated across all of the respondents.
- Quotes from open-ended questions will never be attributed to individuals.
- Any potentially identifying information will be stripped before use.

Please answer the questions to the best of your ability. However, to save time, please feel free to skip any questions where you do not feel you have any particular insights or are not comfortable answering. On the open-ended questions, should you choose to answer, we request that you provide enough detail to ensure that we know what you mean. For example, instead of "identifying talent" you might be more specific and say "identifying the right executive level talent", or "making sure we have enough bench strength among our executive team".

If you have any questions, please contact: Patrick Wright at Patrick.wright@moore.sc.edu.

Demographics

Demographics

1. What is your gender?

- ☐ Female
- ☐ Male
- ☐ Prefer not to answer
- ☐ Other (*please specify*)

2. What is your race/ethnicity?

- ☐ White
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Hispanic or Latino/Latina
- ☐ Asian (East Asian, Southeast Asian, South Asian)
- ☐ Native American, Alaska Native, or Indigenous
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
- ☐ Middle Eastern or North African
- ☐ Mixed Race or Multiracial
- ☐ Prefer Not to Answer
- ☐ Other (*please specify*)

3. How many full-time employees does your company have?

- ☐ 100 to 4,999
- ☐ 5,000 to 24,999
- ☐ 25,000 to 99,999
- ☐ 100,000 to 999,999
- ☐ 1 million or more

4. How long have you been a CHRO?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1 to 4 years
- ☐ 5 to 9 years
- ☐ 10 years or more

5. Is this your first CHRO Role?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

6. What is the budget for your HR department/function?

- ☐ \$1 to \$9.9 million
- ☐ \$10 to \$49.9 million
- ☐ \$50 to \$199.9 million
- ☐ \$200 million or more

7. Over the next three years, do you expect your HR budget to increase, decrease or stay the same?

- ☐ Increase
- ☐ Decrease
- ☐ Stay the same
- ☐ Don't know/not sure

CHRO Roles

CHRO Roles

8. Of the eight components of the Model of a World-Class CHRO listed below, what do you think the **relative effectiveness is of MOST CHROs** (not you)?

	Most Ineffective	Ineffective	Somewhat ineffective	Ne ineff r effe
Functional Business Leader: (Create a future-focused, financially disciplined team to run the HR function)	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Most Ineffective	Ineffective	Somewhat ineffective	Not ineffective or effective
Business Acumen: (Understanding how the firm makes money and developing and aligning all HR processes based on bottom-line impact...or understanding how the firm makes money and considering the financial impact in the design and development all HR processes, initiatives, and activities)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business Strategy: (Participating in and influencing the development of the business strategy)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Board's Leader of Human Capital: (CEO succession, executive compensation, responding to external trends)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Creator of Talent Strategy: (Staffing critical roles, designing talent management processes, directing strategic workforce planning)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enterprise Change Leader: (Challenging the status quo, planning/ implementing enterprise change, managing stakeholders and advocating for employees)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Driver of Culture and Purpose: (Linking purpose to culture, measuring/ communicating the culture, holding leaders accountable for culture promise)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Trusted Advisor and Coach: (Advising/ coaching the CEO, maximizing ELT effectiveness, coach/ develop key enterprise talent)	☐	☐	☐	☐

9. Select the five issues of most immediate concern to you as the lead human resources officer of a major corporation. (*please select only five*)

- ☐ AI and digitization of the workplace (including data privacy and cybersecurity)
- ☐ Backlash against ESG
- ☐ Diversity, equity and inclusion
- ☐ Employee engagement
- ☐ Employee relations (independent contractors, workforce activism)
- ☐ Employee well-being

- ☐ Executive compensation and corporate governance
- ☐ Executive development, including critical role succession
- ☐ Globalization of the company's workforce
- ☐ Health care strategies
- ☐ HR functional development
- ☐ Increased union activity
- ☐ Mergers, acquisitions, and divestitures
- ☐ Organizational change
- ☐ Pay equity and pay transparency
- ☐ Productivity and cost cutting
- ☐ Supervisor and manager capability
- ☐ Talent acquisition and retention
- ☐ Workplace culture/cultural transformation
- ☐ Other (please specify)

C-Suite Succession

C-Suite Succession

10. How did the following executives and you (CHRO) come into the role?

CEO		Internal	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire
		☐	☐	☐
CFO	Internal (from within function)	Internal (from different function)	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire
	☐	☐	☐	☐
CHRO	Internal (from within function)	Internal (from different function)	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire
	☐	☐	☐	☐

General Counsel	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐
CTO/CIO	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐
CMO	Internal (from within function) ☐	Internal (from different function) ☐	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months) ☐	Direct external hire ☐

11. What percentage of your external board members would you describe as being “highly interested” in CEO succession as opposed to mostly just going through the motions.

12. As far as the board is concerned, what do you think the majority believe about the timing of CEO succession?

- ☐ A CEO succession event **will definitely** happen within the next 2 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **might** happen within the next 2 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **will likely** happen in the next 2–5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **might** happen in the next 2–5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **probably won’t** happen until after 5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **definitely won’t** happen until after 5 years

13. To what degree would you agree with the following statements regarding CEO succession?

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree disagree
The CEO is regularly engaged and active with regard to CEO succession planning	☐	☐	☐
The CEO actively makes CEO succession planning a priority	☐	☐	☐
The CEO believes hiring an internal candidate is an indicator of his/her success in developing talent	☐	☐	☐
The CEO objectively evaluates and develops talent.	☐	☐	☐
The CEO believes it is important for him or her to be actively involved in succession planning	☐	☐	☐
The CEO believes the success or failure of the next CEO is an important part of his or her legacy	☐	☐	☐

14. Thinking about where you currently are in regards to CEO succession planning, how effective has the Board been at conducting or overseeing the following activities?

	Not a current activity the Board performs or oversees	Extremely ineffective	Worse than averag
Establishing board authority over the process	☐	☐	☐
Defining a process by which succession planning will occur	☐	☐	☐
Establishing a timeframe in which succession will likely occur	☐	☐	☐
Outlining plans for short-term and longer-term succession scenarios	☐	☐	☐
Considering the timing of other executive succession events and board membership changes	☐	☐	☐
Scanning the company's internal and external environment	☐	☐	☐
Analyzing the company's expected future strategic initiatives to deal with the environment	☐	☐	☐
Building a CEO role profile to address expected future strategic challenge	☐	☐	☐

	Not a current activity the Board performs or oversees	Extremely ineffective	Worse than averag
Specifying the competencies needed to align with the role profile	☐	☐	☐
Identifying internal leaders with CEO potential	☐	☐	☐
Analyzing the external marketplace for executives with leadership potential	☐	☐	☐
Assessing the capabilities of internal talent	☐	☐	☐
Providing opportunities for board member interactions with candidates	☐	☐	☐
Evaluating and ranking candidates based on the role profile	☐	☐	☐
Developing talent management scenarios based on succession selection scenarios	☐	☐	☐
Building diversity in the executive succession candidate pool	☐	☐	☐
Providing opportunities to for candidates to develop necessary skills	☐	☐	☐
Creating new opportunities and roles in the organization for candidates to grow	☐	☐	☐
Identifying outside opportunities for candidates to improve	☐	☐	☐
Providing personalized coaching and mentoring for candidates	☐	☐	☐
Providing developmental opportunities to improve candidate pool diversity	☐	☐	☐
Developing appropriate plans for transition of incoming executives	☐	☐	☐
Developing appropriate plans for transitioning outgoing executives	☐	☐	☐
Notifying candidates of their status in the executive succession pool	☐	☐	☐

New CEO Strategic Moves

15. Has your organization experienced a CEO transition within the last 5 years?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Branch for CEO Strategic moves

16. To what extent has the organization experienced strategic change and disruption since the new CEO took office?

- ☐ Not at all (1)
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ Somewhat (4)
- ☐ 5
- ☐ 6
- ☐ Very Great Extent (7)

17. To what extent have you, the CHRO, been involved in implementing the new CEO's strategic change agenda?

- ☐ Not at all (1)
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ Somewhat (4)
- ☐ 5
- ☐ 6
- ☐ Very Great Extent (7)

18. To what degree has the level of change in the organization affected the ELT's dynamics/culture?

- ☐ Severe Negative Impact (1)
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ Neither Negative nor Positive Impact (4)
- ☐ 5
- ☐ 6
- ☐ Severe Positive Impact (7)

19. How quickly did the CEO begin making significant changes to the organization's strategy and processes?

- ☐ 0 - 3 months
- ☐ 3 - 6 months
- ☐ 6 - 12 months
- ☐ 12-24 months
- ☐ 2+ years

20. What was your role (i.e., the major ways you contributed) in making these changes?

Future Effect of Tariffs

21. How significant do you think an increase in U.S. tariffs will be to your business?

- ☐ Very significant
- ☐ Moderately significant
- ☐ Slightly significant
- ☐ Not very significant
- ☐ Don't know/not sure

BUSINESS LEADERS

BUSINESS LEADERS

22. As you look at the potential impact of Artificial Intelligence over the next 10 years, to what extent do you believe each of the following will be seen:

	Not at all likely	Very unlikely	Unlikely	Neutral	Likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
Increased skill requirements for the vast majority of the workforce	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Increased skill requirements for a small minority of the workforce	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Elimination of certain kinds of jobs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Overall reduction in the size of the workforce	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

23. What do you hope to accomplish with the deployment of AI in your HR practices? (*please select up to 3*)

- ☐ Broadening and increasing pool of talent sources
- ☐ Enhancing productivity and efficiency, and reducing manual workload
- ☐ Fostering learning and development
- ☐ Improving accuracy and objectivity in HR processes
- ☐ Making better talent management decisions

- ☐ Personalizing employee experiences
- ☐ Redefining jobs and roles
- ☐ Strengthening diversity and inclusion efforts
- ☐ Supporting employee well-being and engagement
- ☐ Other (*please specify*)

24. As you look at how AI will develop and be implemented over the next 2-5 years, in what way(s) do you think it will impact the ROLE of leaders in your organization?

25. Given your answer above regarding the changing ROLE of leaders, what COMPETENCIES do you think will become more important?

26. Are you doing anything interesting or unique to build these skills in your leaders, and if so, what are they?

27. As you look at the capabilities of the bulk of leaders in your organization (middle and upper level...not just high

potentials), how would you assess the general level of their competencies in the following areas:

	Extremely Weak (1)	2	Needs Development (3)	4 So
1. Continuous Learning and Development: Lifelong learning, adaptability, and personal growth	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Emotional Intelligence and Empathy: Understand their impact on others, manage emotions, and build strong interpersonal relationships.	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Resilience and Stress Management: Maintaining composure and resilience under pressure	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Integrity and Ethical Standards: Exemplify upholding high ethical standards and acting with integrity in all decisions and actions .	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. People Development and Team Building: Mentoring and coaching their teams, helping them grow and fostering a collaborative, high-performance environment.	☐	☐	☐	☐
6. Collaboration and Inclusivity: Promoting teamwork, valuing diversity, and ensuring inclusivity.	☐	☐	☐	☐
7. Communication and Transparency: Open, clear, and honest communication builds trust and strengthens team relationships, ensuring alignment and clarity.	☐	☐	☐	☐
8. Accountability and Ethical Leadership: Holding oneself and others accountable while fostering an environment of integrity within the team.	☐	☐	☐	☐
9. Strategic Thinking and Visionary Leadership: Setting long-term strategies, anticipating trends, and driving innovation to shape the organization's future.	☐	☐	☐	☐
10. Innovation and Change Management: Managing change, encouraging innovation, and remaining agile to ensure the organization stays competitive.	☐	☐	☐	☐
11. Customer Focus and Result Orientation: Prioritize customer needs and align their team's work with the organization's goals to achieve sustainable results.	☐	☐	☐	☐
12. Digital and Technological Dexterity: Leveraging digital tools and technological innovation to improve organizational processes and decision-making.	☐	☐	☐	☐

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Approaches

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Approaches

28. What diversity initiatives does your company maintain right now? *(please select all that apply)*

- ☐ ERGs
- ☐ Mentorship programs
- ☐ Participation in outside culture surveys
- ☐ Setting internal (non-public) quantitative goals
- ☐ Setting public quantitative goals
- ☐ Supplier diversity programs
- ☐ Training (that is not legally required)
- ☐ Tying DEI metrics to executive pay
- ☐ Other *(please specify)*
- ☐ None

29. Do you intend to make significant changes to your DEI programs in 2025?

- ☐ Yes, expand
- ☐ Yes, contract
- ☐ No
- ☐ Don't know/not sure

30. How will the following change?

	Decrease	Same	Increase
ERGs	☐	☐	☐
Mentorship programs	☐	☐	☐
Participation in outside culture surveys	☐	☐	☐
Setting internal (non-public) quantitative goals	☐	☐	☐
Setting public quantitative goals	☐	☐	☐

	Decrease	Same	Increase
Supplier diversity programs	☐	☐	☐
Training (that is not legally required)	☐	☐	☐
Tying DEI metrics to executive pay	☐	☐	☐

31. Do you intend to change the name from DEI to something else?

- ☐ Yes, we have already changed the name
- ☐ Yes, we plan to change the name.
- ☐ Maybe/unsure at this time.
- ☐ No, we do not plan to change the name.

32. If you answered yes to the above, what have you or are you changing the name to?

33. Do you intend to reduce disclosure around your DEI activities? *(please select all that apply)*

- ☐ Yes, on the website
- ☐ Yes, in public filings such as proxy/10K
- ☐ Yes, in sustainability report
- ☐ No
- ☐ Don't know/not sure

34. As you look at the change in US presidential administrations, what is the most important way, if any,

you see your policies/programs related to DEI changing over the next 2 years?

Sustainability

Sustainability

Q35. During the new US Presidential administration, how do you anticipate your company will change its:

	Substantially Decrease (1)	Slightly Decrease (2)	No Change (3)	Slightly Increase (4)	Substantially Increase (5)
COMMITMENT to environmental sustainability practices	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Environmental sustainability REPORTING	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TEAM devoted to environmental sustainability	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

36. Why do you anticipate your company will change its approach to environmental sustainability in the way described in the previous questions during the new US Presidential administration?

37. To what extent do you outsource aspects of your environmental sustainability reporting (e.g., conducting materiality assessment, measuring impact, generating reports)?

- ☐ We do not outsource any of our sustainability reporting. (1)
- ☐ We outsource a small portion of our sustainability reporting. (2)
- ☐ We outsource about half of our sustainability reporting. (3)
- ☐ We outsource most of our sustainability reporting. (4)
- ☐ We outsource the vast majority of our sustainability reporting. (5)

Sustainability Branch for Q35

38. To what extent do you anticipate bringing any outsourced aspects of your sustainability reporting in house?

- ☐ We do not anticipate bringing any aspects of our sustainability reporting in house. (1)
- ☐ We anticipate bringing a small portion of our sustainability reporting in-house. (2)
- ☐ We anticipate bringing about half of our sustainability reporting in-house. (3)
- ☐ We anticipate bringing most of our sustainability reporting in-house. (4)
- ☐ We plan to fully bring all outsourced aspects of our sustainability reporting in-house. (5)

Additional DEI Question

39. You have now completed the HRP/CES part of the survey. The academic researchers would greatly

appreciate your participation in a brief additional survey focused on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI). The goal is to identify the DEI practices you WILL be using AS WELL AS those you WILL NOT be using. We want to gather this data in order to respond to some of the recent criticisms levelled at DEI. If you are willing to continue, please select "Yes" below:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Branch if YES for Additional DEI

40. Research has identified different approaches to DEI, some of which are outlier practices that have received recent criticism as actually or potentially illegal in the popular press and which some advocates are using to put excessive pressure on companies to eliminate their DEI programs entirely. On the other hand, some other DEI practices are legal and effective and should be maintained. The statements below represent these DIFFERENT approaches. In order to understand on what companies are ACTUALLY DOING AND NOT DOING with regard to DEI practice, please indicate the extent to which you believe each of the statements below will characterize how your company will be approaching DEI OVER THE NEXT FEW YEARS. If you do NOT plan on using a practice, simply mark the "Not at All" category:

	Not at All (1)	Unlikely (2)	Neutral (3)	Likely (4)	Definitely (5)
a. My organization demonstrates that only the experiences and insights of employees from historically marginalized groups are critical to shaping DEI policies.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not at All (1)	Unlikely (2)	Neutral (3)	Likely (4)	Definitely (5)
b. My organization demonstrates that the experiences and insights of all employees, regardless of group identity , are critical in shaping DEI policies.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. My organization requires job candidates to write or sign a diversity statement as their commitment to policies that address injustices and biases faced by marginalized groups.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. My organization has no requirements of job candidates to write or sign a diversity statement.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. My organization supports employee resource groups based on gender, racial or ethnic identities that exclude organizational members with other identities from engaging in their activities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. My organization supports employee resource groups based on different gender, racial or ethnic identities, but allows organizational members with other identities to engage in their activities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. My organization considers an incident as biased or discriminatory only if it negatively impacts an employee from a historically marginalized group .	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
h. My organization considers an incident as biased or discriminatory based on its nature and impact, regardless of the identity of the affected employee .	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
i. My organization has a strong focus on achieving equity through preferential hiring or promotion of women and/or members from historically marginalized communities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
j. My organization has a strong focus on achieving equity through impartial hiring and promotion processes, regardless of an individual's background.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not at All (1)	Unlikely (2)	Neutral (3)	Likely (4)	Definitely (5)
k. My organization maintains DEI initiatives that are designed to actively rectify past injustices in society through preferential hiring or promotion practices.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
l. My organization maintains DEI initiatives that focus on building a future where every individual, regardless of identity group, has an equal opportunity to succeed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
m. My organization emphasizes how DEI can be used as a tool for social justice.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
n. My organization emphasizes how DEI can be used to strengthen the business.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
o. My organization focuses on specific quotas in hiring and promotion related to advancing historically underrepresented groups.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
p. My organization does not focus on specific quotas in hiring and promotion related to advancing historically underrepresented groups	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
q. My organization maintains hiring and promotion practices that de-emphasize merit, and instead emphasize membership in historically marginalized groups.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
r. My organization maintains hiring and promotion practices that are highly merit-based for all employees.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
s. My organization administers DEI training that focuses on exploring the unconscious biases held by majority group members.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
t. My organization administers DEI training that focuses on exploring the unconscious biases that could be held by any group member, regardless of majority or minority group status.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐